

Guru Gobind Singh was the tenth and the last Sikh Guru. He was born in 1666 A.D. in Patna (Bihar). He introduced 'Khalsa Panth' and consolidated the Sikh community as a warrior.

Maratha State and Confederacy

1. Where was the capital of Shivaji?

- (a) Raigarh (b) Sindhurg
(c) Poona (d) Kolhapur

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Shivaji was coronated in 1674 A.D. with the title of 'Chhatrapati' and made Raigarh his capital. Vishveshwar (Gaga Bhatt), the famous contemporary scholar of Benares (Banaras), coronated and declared him Kshatriya.

2. 'Ashta Pradhan' was helping in Administration of which ruler?

- (a) Babur (b) Akbar
(c) Aurangzeb (d) Shivaji
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

'Ashta Pradhan' was a council of eight ministers constituted by Shivaji in Maratha administration.

The eight ministers were –

- (i) Peshwa- Prime Minister of King
(ii) Amatya or Mazumdar- Finance and Revenue Minister
(iii) Wakianavis/Mantri- Interior minister, managing internal affairs, especially intelligence and espionage.
(iv) Sachiv/Surnavis-Responsible for all correspondence.
(v) Sumant/Dabir- Foreign Minister
(vi) Senapati/Sar-i-Naubat - Maintenance of appointments, organization and food supply of military.
(vii) Pandit Rao- High Priest
(viii) Nyayadhish- Chief Justice

3. 'Ashta Pradhan' was a Council of Ministers

- (a) in the Gupta administration
(b) in the Chola administration
(c) in the Maratha administration
(d) in the Vijayanagara administration

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

4. Who established Ashta Pradhan?

- (a) Chandragupta (b) Ashoka
(c) Harshavardhana (d) Shivaji
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. Saranzami system was related to –

- (a) Land revenue system of Maratha
(b) Taluqdari system
(c) Qutb Shahi administration
(d) None of the above

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Saranzami system was related to land revenue in the Maratha period. The land given under Saranzami system was provided for the livelihood of Maratha Jagirdar during the Maratha period.

Disintegration of the Mughal Empire

1. Who was the last Mughal Emperor to sit on Mayur Singhasan?

- (a) Shah Alam I (b) Muhammad Shah
(c) Bahadur Shah (d) Jahandar Shah

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

Muhammad Shah (1719 - 1748 A.D.) was the last Mughal emperor to sit on Mayur Singhasan/ Takht-i-Taus during his reign. Nadir Shah attacked India in 1739 A.D. and defeated the Mughals in Karnal Battle. The contemporary historian Anand Ram Mukhlis wrote, "Nadir Shah took sixty thousand rupees, many thousands of gold coins, gold of one crore rupee, jewels of fifty crores, Kohinoor and Peacock throne with him to Iran".

2. Which of the following Mughal emperors was not allowed to enter into Delhi by Wazir Ghaziuddin?

- (a) Alamgir- II (b) Shah Alam- II
(c) Akbar- II (d) Bahadur Shah- II

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

Shah Alam- II tenure was from 1759 to 1806 A.D. His real name was Ali Gauhar. He became the victim of conspiracies hatched at the royal court. He reached Delhi with the help of Marathas in 1772 A.D. During his rule only, English captured Delhi in 1803 A.D.